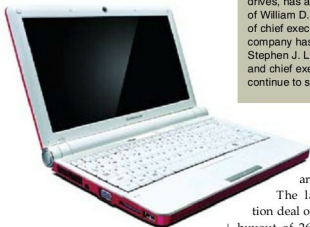


Industry News

Netbooks becoming popular

Netbooks are getting focus of vendors as the Indian PC market seems to be slowing down. Leading makers like Lenovo, Acer, Samsung and Dell believe the main driver for netbook sales would be their competitive pricing over notebooks. The average price of a netbook is Rs 20,000, while an entry-level notebook costs upwards of Rs 30,000.

The current sales volume of netbooks is pegged at some 25,000 units. It is projected to grow to 200,000-300,000 units in the next one year. Acer recently launched a net-



Netbook by Lenovo

book at Rs 14,990. It expects such an aggressive pricing will trigger further growth.

Telecom industry inks M&A deals worth \$9 billion

The fast growing Indian telecommunications industry has witnessed mergers and acquisitions (M&A) valued at over \$9 billion this fiscal, despite the global economic slowdown, according to a study by ASSOCHAM EcoPulse. In fact, out of the total M&A deals sealed in

Apple gets new CEO

Apple's chief executive Steve Jobs is facing some health-related problems and needs to take a medical leave for some time. He has appointed Timothy D. Cook as the new CEO.

In his position as COO, Cook was responsible for all of the company's worldwide sales and operations, including end-to-end management of Apple's supply chain, sales activities, and service and support in all markets and countries. He also heads Apple's Macintosh division.

Seagate replaces CEO

Seagate Technology, the world's largest maker of computer hard disk drives, has announced the departure of William D. Watkins from the role of chief executive officer (CEO). The company has appointed chairman Stephen J. Luczo as its new president and chief executive officer. Luczo will continue to serve as chairman of the

board of directors.

Raju's quit Satyam

Satyam Computer Services' founder chairman B. Ramalinga Raju and managing director B. Rama Raju have resigned from the company's board, pushing the company into a deep crisis. A fraud to the tune of Rs 50.4 billion in the balance sheet of the company came to the fore as Ramalinga Raju confessed to indulging in massive financial fraud like inflating the books for several years.

Emerson Network appoints new president

Emerson Network Power has appointed Stephen Liang as president for the Emerson Network Power Systems business in Asia Pacific. Liang, who has led Emerson Network Power in China for the past eight years, will take on the additional role of president, Emerson Network Power Systems Asia.

the country, the telecommunications industry accounted for around one-third of them.

The largest telecommunication deal of the year came from the buyout of 26 per cent stake in Tata Teleservices by Japanese major NTT DoCoMo Inc.

3G, broadband to contribute half of telecom revenues

The 3G subscriber base is expected to reach 90 million in five years, as per a study by FICCI. 3G and broadband wireless access are expected to account for almost half the revenues from wireless services four years down the line. In the Indian market, which is predominantly voice-based, 3G will help increase the contribution of non-voice services like SMS and data card

access to 23 per cent from 9 per cent at present.

In a recent development, SOMA Networks has tied up with Bharat Sanchar Nigam Limited (BSNL) for providing mobile WiMAX products and professional services in Gujarat. Gujarat will be the first circle in the country to witness WiMAX services by BSNL followed by Andhra Pradesh, Maharashtra and Goa.

Airtel, Vodafone networks most congested

Bharti Airtel and Vodafone Essar have the most congested telecom networks, reveals the Telecommunications Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI). The regulator, which has been monitoring the traffic on a monthly basis, said that the congest-

In Focus